

Ideally, you'll only need to use light and medium braking, but you can always use firm or emergency braking if you need to. As a braking technique, imagine having a cup of water in your lap that you don't want to spill.

Keep the people behind you in mind, also. Unnecessary firm or emergency braking could surprise the people behind you who were anticipating a smooth stop.

ANTILOCK BRAKING SYSTEMS

A vehicle's Antilock Brake System (ABS) offers an important safety advantage by allowing drivers to steer during an emergency braking situation. An ABS does not shorten your stopping distance, but it will allow you to keep better steering control. When engaged, you can feel your vehicle shake a bit.

Practice firm or emergency braking in a large, open, and paved space. Hit the brakes hard, and feel the ABS keep the wheels from locking up.

2.9 | ACCELERATING

To drive smoothly, you'll want to be familiar and comfortable with different levels of acceleration. There could be times you're in stop-and-go traffic where the only acceleration you need is to release the brake pedal. There could be times you'll need to accelerate quickly to avoid a hazard. Your accelerating technique should be like braking — imagine there's a cup of water in your lap, and accelerate without spilling the water.

